

USER PERSONA DEVELOPMENT

1.1 Persona Requirements

The two user personas who are part of the targeted audience is the undergraduate student (First-year) and a Senior student in an African higher education institution. The following people will address the student concerns and challenges they come across when it comes to buying and selling second-hand textbooks for an affordable price.

1.2 Persona

Persona 1: The Seller

Name: Rendani Maita

Demographic

Age: 23

Occupation: Second year university student

Location: Pretoria, Gauteng

Type of device: Samsung Android phone

Goals

His goal is to sell his previous year's textbook to first year students in the same institution. Aiding other students by allowing them to buy expensive books at an affordable price. Easy and fast to find a buyer.

Motivations

His motivation is to help other students by selling used textbooks to them, so that they can manage on their own despite their tight budgets. It also raises environmental awareness by encouraging students to reuse textbooks rather than leaving them unused or discarding them.

Pain points

Poor communication on where to meet, at what time. It takes longer to find someone to buy the book through social media.

In conclusion Rendani Maita who is senior student, needs a good application that will help with communicating and scheduling appointments as he values punctuality.

Persona: The Buyer

Name: Precious Makau

Demographic

Age: 19

Occupation: First year university student (Undergraduate)

Location: Pretoria, Gauteng

Type of device: Tecno

Goals

The goal is to find an affordable second-hand textbook, with the assurance that she is purchasing it from a trusted student. To access the textbooks fast, before or at the beginning of the semester.

Motivations

It will boost her academic performance since she will have the required textbooks on time. She will also save some money since she depends on NSFAS, which sometimes experience delays.

Pain Points

Since she is a first-year student, it's difficult for her to know which sellers are trustworthy and which ones are scammers. The brand-new textbooks are expensive in bookstores, and she doesn't have enough money to buy brand new books.

In conclusion Precious Makau is an undergraduate student (first year), who needs a simple and clean interface to interact with, which will be also offering an appointment scheduling for safe meet-up.

1.3Persona Accuracy and Relevance

The above personas clearly show the struggle that African students are facing, like not able to buy expensive textbooks and the inability to find second-hand textbooks from marketplaces on time. The personas need an app/resource-friendly operation with a design that will be simple to use, which will offer appointment scheduling for safety and selling or buying of textbooks at an affordable price.